SUPERR SELECTOR SEASON 2 · ROUND 1

Reliable players under pressure

Evidence report for Rajasthan Royals' IPL 2027 auction strategy
Player order matches the names currently selected in the Unstop form

Data window	Evidence base	Selections
IPL + T20I	**853**	**20**
2022–2026	matches · 194,014 deliveries	10 batters · 10 bowlers

Executive summary

This report ranks the currently selected names by evidence of performance in defined high-pressure states. Each player is compared with their own ordinary-play baseline within the same format and season. Batter and bowler metrics remain separate; the score is an evidence-ranking index, not a probability or certainty claim.

> **Decision distinction:** Unstop selection position is shown separately from pressure-consensus rank. The selected form order includes release-dependent and currently unlisted players. It is a submission order, not an assertion that every player is available to RR in 2027.

RR fit context

RR's 2026 roster includes Yashasvi Jaiswal and Ravindra Jadeja; both are internal references rather than auction targets. RR's 2025–26 phase audit points to powerplay bowling control as a review priority (conceded rate 9.41 to 10.43 per six legal balls), while death bowling improved (12.71 to 11.06). A rumoured RR–LSG trade was unconfirmed and unnamed as of this report; treat incoming/outgoing role needs conditionally.

The supplied pressure brief does not provide age or uncapped status. This ranking does not invent those filters. Confirm each candidate's role, current form, 2027 retention/release, auction registration, age, cap status, injury and availability before making final RR recommendations.

Methodology

Data preparation

Included IPL seasons and T20Is from 2022 onward, joined deliveries to match and competition records, excluded unrelated T20 leagues and super-over innings, and reconstructed pre-ball score, wickets, legal balls, scheduled balls and chase requirement. Revised targets were used where supplied. Ordinary rows with a default extras1_runs value were not counted as extras unless extras_type was populated. Wides and oversteps are not legal balls; byes and leg-byes are legal but not charged to bowlers.

Pressure state

A delivery is pressure-tagged if at least one condition applies before the ball: (1) second-innings chase requires 9+ runs per over; (2) chase requires 7.5+ per over in its final 30 legal balls with six or fewer wickets left; (3) final five innings overs with five or fewer wickets; (4) collapse recovery after 30 legal balls with three or fewer wickets; or (5) final 10 scheduled overs in a knockout. Narrow and Broad definitions adjust these thresholds. These operational cutoffs are transparent choices, not an official pressure definition.

Role-specific metrics and ranking

Batters: 75% standardized strike-rate lift and 25% standardized dismissal-rate improvement versus own ordinary baseline. **Bowlers:** 60% standardized economy improvement and 40% standardized credited wicket-rate improvement. Season-format evidence is weighted by square-root pressure-ball volume and recency; format share is capped at 60% when both formats are present.

Eligibility requires at least 60 pressure legal balls, 120 ordinary legal balls, eight effective pressure matches, and minimum season-format baseline exposure. Pressure skill shrinks by n/(n+60); consistency is Beta(4,4)-shrunk. Core index = 50 + 10 × (shrunk skill z + 0.20 consistency z), clipped to 0–100. The displayed consensus rank is the mean rank over Core, Narrow and Broad definitions; a player must qualify under at least two.

> **Reliability caveat:** the pack has no labeled clutch outcome, so supervised accuracy cannot be calculated. This is a transparent descriptive ranking, not a trained clutch classifier. Top-10 overlap with Core/Narrow/Broad definitions is 6/6/6 for batters and 8/7/8 for bowlers.

Selected batters

Order follows the current Unstop form. “Pressure rank” is the model’s cross-definition consensus position among all eligible batters; a lower number means stronger overall rank. The core index is relative to the eligible batting pool only.

Unstop order	Player	Pressure rank	Core index	Pressure balls	Matches	Formats	Evidence	IPL 2026 mapping
1	**Reeza Hendricks**	1	70.4	389	15	T20I	Pressure strike rate 171.0 vs ordinary 122.4 (lift +48.6); pressure dismissals 2.6/100 balls vs 7.0. Baseline met in 73% of pressure matches.	Not listed in 2026 IPL mapping
2	**Ryan Burl**	2	61.8	200	19	T20I	Pressure strike rate 146.3 vs ordinary 107.7 (lift +38.6); pressure dismissals 3.5/100 balls vs 4.1. Baseline met in 68% of pressure matches.	Not listed in 2026 IPL mapping
3	**Mohammad Nabi**	3	63.8	145	26	T20I	Pressure strike rate 165.6 vs ordinary 112.7 (lift +52.9); pressure dismissals 6.1/100 balls vs 4.5. Baseline met in 73% of pressure matches.	Not listed in 2026 IPL mapping
4	**Pathum Nissanka**	4	62.4	472	22	T20, T20I	Pressure strike rate 161.6 vs ordinary 128.1 (lift +33.5); pressure dismissals 3.7/100 balls vs 4.9. Baseline met in 68% of pressure matches.	Delhi Capitals
5	**Jaker Ali Anik**	6	57.6	235	17	T20I	Pressure strike rate 149.2 vs ordinary 112.1 (lift +37.1); pressure dismissals 5.9/100 balls vs 3.7. Baseline met in 59% of pressure matches.	Not listed in 2026 IPL mapping
6	**David Miller**	7	58.0	381	46	T20	Pressure strike rate 160.9 vs ordinary 123.7 (lift +37.3); pressure dismissals 4.4/100 balls vs 3.1. Baseline met in 50% of pressure matches.	Delhi Capitals
7	**Shahbaz Ahmed**	8	59.1	199	20	T20	Pressure strike rate 142.1 vs ordinary 103.9 (lift +38.2); pressure dismissals 6.0/100 balls vs 3.4. Baseline met in 70% of pressure matches.	Lucknow Super Giants
8	**Mark Chapman**	14	59.4	290	19	T20I	Pressure strike rate 150.9 vs ordinary 129.5 (lift +21.4); pressure dismissals 4.0/100 balls vs 5.7. Baseline met in 74% of pressure matches.	Not listed in 2026 IPL mapping
9	**Sikandar Raza**	23	52.1	242	26	T20I	Pressure strike rate 144.2 vs ordinary 127.5 (lift +16.7); pressure dismissals 6.6/100 balls vs 4.0. Baseline met in 62% of pressure matches.	Not listed in 2026 IPL mapping
10	**Brian Bennett**	28	55.2	223	16	T20I	Pressure strike rate 144.6 vs ordinary 123.9 (lift +20.7); pressure dismissals 6.9/100 balls vs 4.7. Baseline met in 75% of pressure matches.	Not listed in 2026 IPL mapping

How to read the batter evidence

Hendricks leads the eligible batter consensus, with a +48.6 pressure strike-rate lift across 389 balls and 15 pressure matches. Burl and Nabi also show strong strike-rate gains; Nabi’s dismissal rate rises against baseline, so the high scoring rate comes with a survival tradeoff. Nissanka and Miller combine substantial samples with positive strike-rate lifts. Jaker Ali has a +37.1 lift, but a smaller 17-match sample. Shahbaz Ahmed’s pressure SR exceeds his baseline by 38.2; his role as an all-rounder should be verified against RR’s actual vacancy. Chapman, Raza and Bennett are ranked 14th, 23rd and 28th in the consensus, so their inclusion is a deeper-pool availability hedge rather than top-10 pressure consensus.

Selected bowlers

Order follows the current Unstop form. Lower economy than own baseline and higher credited wickets per over are positive; some selected names sit outside the pressure consensus top 10.

Unstop order	Player	Pressure rank	Core index	Pressure balls	Matches	Formats	Evidence	IPL 2026 mapping
1	**Mohammad Nawaz**	1	68.1	301	26	T20I	Pressure economy 6.21 vs ordinary 7.48 (-1.27 runs/over); credited wickets 0.64/over vs 0.28. Baseline met in 69% of pressure matches.	Not listed in 2026 IPL mapping
2	**Benjamin Sears**	7	59.2	136	12	T20I	Pressure economy 7.59 vs ordinary 8.50 (-0.91 runs/over); credited wickets 0.52/over vs 0.33. Baseline met in 67% of pressure matches.	Not listed in 2026 IPL mapping
3	**Reece Topley**	15	64.9	242	18	T20, T20I	Pressure economy 7.45 vs ordinary 9.94 (-2.48 runs/over); credited wickets 0.30/over vs 0.21. Baseline met in 72% of pressure matches.	Not listed in 2026 IPL mapping
4	**Mohammad Rishad Hossain**	16	57.3	343	26	T20I	Pressure economy 8.09 vs ordinary 8.79 (-0.69 runs/over); credited wickets 0.47/over vs 0.31. Baseline met in 54% of pressure matches.	Not listed in 2026 IPL mapping
5	**Taskin Ahmed**	25	57.8	250	31	T20I	Pressure economy 7.73 vs ordinary 7.51 (+0.22 runs/over); credited wickets 0.74/over vs 0.36. Baseline met in 45% of pressure matches.	Not listed in 2026 IPL mapping
6	**Barry McCarthy**	26	56.5	90	19	T20I	Pressure economy 7.62 vs ordinary 7.80 (-0.19 runs/over); credited wickets 0.39/over vs 0.05. Baseline met in 47% of pressure matches.	Not listed in 2026 IPL mapping
7	**Gudakesh Motie**	27	57.3	181	17	T20I	Pressure economy 8.62 vs ordinary 8.22 (+0.40 runs/over); credited wickets 0.54/over vs 0.15. Baseline met in 47% of pressure matches.	Not listed in 2026 IPL mapping
8	**Richard Ngarava**	30	55.3	181	22	T20I	Pressure economy 7.63 vs ordinary 8.01 (-0.39 runs/over); credited wickets 0.47/over vs 0.25. Baseline met in 45% of pressure matches.	Not listed in 2026 IPL mapping
9	**Gerald Coetzee**	11	66.0	138	18	T20, T20I	Pressure economy 6.80 vs ordinary 8.36 (-1.55 runs/over); credited wickets 0.62/over vs 0.23. Baseline met in 61% of pressure matches.	Sunrisers Hyderabad
10	**Liam Dawson**	37	57.5	133	11	T20I	Pressure economy 7.66 vs ordinary 8.58 (-0.92 runs/over); credited wickets 0.52/over vs 0.33. Baseline met in 55% of pressure matches.	Not listed in 2026 IPL mapping

How to read the bowler evidence

In the selected group, Nawaz has the strongest consensus evidence (rank 1): economy improves by 1.27 runs/over and credited wickets rise from 0.28 to 0.64 per over. Coetzee (consensus 11) shows a 1.55 economy improvement and 0.62 credited wickets/over. Topley (15) has a 2.48 economy improvement. Rishad Hossain (16) adds wicket-rate lift with a modest economy improvement. Taskin's wicket rate improves strongly, while economy is slightly worse than baseline; assess that tradeoff rather than relying on wickets alone. The remaining names are deeper-rank options, with individual sample sizes and conditions shown above.

RR planning scenarios & limitations

Release case

If other franchises release players, the role-screening lists should be checked against the 2027 official pool. Batter candidates from the 2026 external-team mapping depend on release: Pathum Nissanka, David Miller, Shahbaz Ahmed, Ryan Rickelton, Tilak Varma, Jitesh Sharma. Bowling candidates include Vyshak Kumar, Nitish Reddy, Anshul Kamboj, Jamie Overton, Vipraj Nigam, Gerald Coetzee, Yash Thakur, Jasprit Bumrah and Mitchell Santner. This scenario is hypothetical and does not assert any actual release.

No external releases

Use candidates absent from the pack's 2026 IPL team mapping as a starting pool, not as verified free agents. This includes the selected names such as Hendricks, Burl, Nabi, Jaker Ali, Mark Chapman, Sikandar Raza and Brian Bennett on batting; and Sears, Topley, Rishad Hossain, Taskin, McCarthy, Motie, Ngarava and Dawson on bowling. Verify registration, age, uncapped status, current form, role, workload, nationality/overseas slots, injury and price.

Trade branch

The 6 Nov RR–LSG report described an unconfirmed multi-player discussion and did not name players. If completed, remove the exact incoming role from generic need and replace the outgoing role; if not completed, use the base-case team gap. Do not treat rumor as roster fact.

Limitations

Small samples, opponent and venue differences, batting position, role, incomplete archives, DLS reconstruction, league-strength differences and identity matching can affect the order. The pack has no ages, cap status, auction price, availability or injury record. Recent match form and final eligibility require external verification and human scouting. These lists cannot support a 95% accuracy claim; they are ranking evidence, not an accuracy-tested prediction.

Sources and privacy

Sources: supplied Round 1 brief and data pack; IPL 2026 retentions; RR 2026 squad; official 2026 trade notice; unconfirmed RR–LSG report, 6 Nov. The private CSV pack is not included in the dashboard repository. Only selected-candidate summary metrics and competition submission analysis are displayed.

Rajasthan Royals-inspired visual identity uses blue/navy, pink and gold. This is an independent participant submission, not an official Rajasthan Royals product.